

AMNIOTIC FLUID

Your baby excretes and reabsorbs about 18 fl oz (0.5 liter) of urine daily, and the amniotic fluid reaches a peak volume of 35 fl oz (1 liter) at 35 weeks. After this time the volume starts to decline and can be as little as 3.5–7 fl oz (100–200 ml) in an overdue pregnancy (see [Induction of labor](#)).

Low levels of amniotic fluid, known as [oligohydramnios](#), can be a sign of a growth-restricted baby or a baby with kidney problems. Excessive amniotic fluid, known as [polyhydramnios](#), may be seen in twin or triplet pregnancies, and is also associated with physical abnormalities in the baby or diabetes in the mother.

At 41 weeks, induction (see [Induction of labor](#)) is usually recommended. If you do not want to be induced, you will have an ultrasound to check the amount of fluid around the baby. If the level is low, it is advisable to be induced.